

Samsung SGH-T500 Mobile Phone

One for the ladies

The first thing that you notice about the SGH-T500 is the external display surrounded by bright gem-shaped tiny LEDs. This phone has an excellent build quality and feels quite sturdy. It is extremely lightweight and is available in Ruby Red, Sapphire Blue, Pearl White and Topaz Gold.

The 32 zirconium stones lining the external display double-up as service indicators and flash in the selected colour namely, violet, blue, sky blue, green, or orange. The keys are flat and lack depth, but large enough to be used comfortably, and sport a blue backlight. Two soft keys at the top of the keypad access the menu and the phonebook; the cancel key is placed in between. The four-way scroll key features an Internet shortcut key in the centre. You can store 500 contacts apart from those stored on the SIM card, and can assign different ring tones and service light colours to your contacts.

The phone has a voice memo feature, which allows you to save three records of 35 seconds each. Not really a phone for SMS junkies, the T500 does not support concatenated messages, and though it does have predictive text input, you cannot add new words to the dictionary. Other key features include polyphonic ring tones, a scheduler, alarm, calculator, To-Do list, world time, con-

version, timer, stopwatch, WAP 1.2.1 and three games. Though the phone supports picture messaging, it does not support MMS or other connectivity options such as InfraRed and Bluetooth.

More features that mark this as a lady's phone are calorie and fitness calculators, biorhythm and a pink scheduler for menstrual cycles. Even the internal LCD display doubles as a vanity mirror when turned off!

The T500 normally offers a good degree of voice clarity, but faces a few problems in areas of low network coverage. Also, since the keys lack depth, the two small rubber pegs at the bottom of the keypad get in the way when using the two corner keys.

Looking at the hefty price tag of almost Rs 30,000, it may make better sense to go in for high-end handsets, such as the Nokia 7650 or the Nokia 7250, which have digital cameras and cost less—especially if you don't care for stereotypes.

SPECIFICATIONS

80 gms, dual display (external monochrome 96 x 64 pixels, internal 65,000 colours 128 x 128 pixels), GSM 900/1800, Li-Ion 720 mAh battery, up to 200 hours standby time, up to 3 hours talk time, three games: Bowling, HamsterBox, HoneyBall

Samsung SGH-T500 Mobile Phone

B+

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 29,099

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Samsung ML-1710 Laser Printer

The best things come in small packages

The ML-1710 is the latest addition to Samsung's extensive line of laser printers. The ML-1710 comes in a milky white body, decorated in slate grey. Despite its small size of 13.7 x 14 x 7.6 inches, the printer features a removable paper tray capable of holding around 250 sheets. The upper body serves as the output tray but can hold only about 40 sheets, after which the papers start flying around—a very small flap is provided to hold the printouts in place.

As far as specifications are concerned, the ML-1710 boasts an 8 MB memory buffer, which is quite effective as can be seen from its performance—the downside is that the memory can't be upgraded. The printer comes with a USB 1.1 interface. Samsung has done a good job of providing drivers for a host of operating systems, including all Windows versions and support for many Linux distributions. The drivers also have features such as watermarking and high altitude correction.

The bundled accessories include a 15A power cord and an extensive manual, but no USB data cable, which is quite strange for a USB printer.

The printer also comes with a Toner Save button that claims to save around 40 per cent in ink consumption. The front panel consists of just one multi-functional button and two indicating LED's. The



printer also supports a manual paper feed mechanism, located on the front side.

The ML-1710 is the fastest and the smallest laser printer available in India. It was able to print 15 pages in one minute—only 2 pages short of the claimed 17 ppm printing speed. The quality of the output was also great, considering the speed of printing. It printed the test image and combination document in just 17 seconds and 22 seconds respectively—by far the fastest we have seen.

Priced at Rs 16,000, the printer is ideally suited for a typical small office or as a home printing solution, and is a good buy for those on the lookout for a small, fast, good quality laser printer.

It may not be suitable for a large organisation due to the lack of networking capabilities, the smaller paper capacity and poor paper handling.

SPECIFICATIONS

66 MHz processor, 8 MB memory, 15 ppm, media type supported: A4 and smaller, special media such as transparencies, envelopes and postcards.

Samsung ML-1710 Laser Printer

B+

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 16,000

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